Erragudi is a good place to begin looking at this full anthology of edicts, its uniqueness being that it is the only site where both the early messages and the new ones are found together. At Kandahar there are two different Ashokan inscriptions as well, but not on the same set of rocks.[22]

When setting down the new message, the first modification made and one that his subjects at Erragudi would have noticed, was an addition to Ashoka's early title, 'Priyadarshin, Beloved of the Gods'. Now, for the first time, Ashoka was called a king. This king did not begin by recounting what he had instituted in the five-odd years since Kalinga, but with an enunciation of dhamma concerned primarily with protecting animals from mindless sacrificial ceremonies:

> Here no living being should be slaughtered for sacrifice.
>
> And also no festive gathering should be held.
>
> For the Beloved of the Gods sees manifold evil in festive gatherings.
>
> There is (however) one kind of festive gathering, which is considered good by king Priyadarshin, Beloved of the Gods.[23]

Alongside this proscription is the intent to prohibit festive gatherings ('samajas') involving animal sacrifice. This was a departure from how Ashoka had enunciated his idea of morality a few years earlier: the first minor rock edict mentions kindness to living beings without outlining prohibitions. Now, 'restraint' orders were proclaimed near towns.[24] While the location of ancient settlement in the vicinity of Erragudi where this order would have been known remains unclear, elsewhere it was inscribed either near or at urban centres, at Girnar and Sannathi, for instance, which were provincial capitals. The Orissa edicts are at Dhauli, not far from a fortified town, and at Jaugada, within the ramparts of a fort. Although the exact location of the Sopara message is not known since only fragments of three edicts were found, we know that Sopara was a thriving port in western India. Towards the north-west, Shahbazgarhi and Mansehra were, as noted, strategically important on account of trade routes.[25] The populace in all